

# Steve J. Franz

(724) 977-1109

stephenfranz22@gmail.com

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## SUMMARY

Backend-focused developer with a background in math and computer science education, experienced in building and deploying full-stack applications using Flask, SQLite, and JavaScript. Skilled in system-level problem solving, backend design, and writing clean, scalable code. Passionate about applying analytical and instructional expertise to collaborative, remote software development teams.

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## EDUCATION

### **Bachelors of Science | Computer Science (*Expected 2027*)**

Western Governors University, Salt Lake City, UT

### **Graduate Certificate | Mathematics (Statistics Focus)**

Youngstown State University, Youngstown, Ohio

### **Bachelor of Science | Mathematics - Secondary Education**

Youngstown State University, Youngstown, Ohio

### **Master of Science | Education**

Westminster College, New Wilmington, Pennsylvania

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## TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, JavaScript, Bash, Swift, Objective-C (prior)
- **Tools & Frameworks:** Flask, Git, Docker, SQLite, Jinja, REST APIs
- **Concepts:** Backend Development, Network Architecture, Systems Programming, Cloud Fundamentals
- **Certifications:** CompTIA A+ (2025–2028), CCNA (2011–2015)
- **Familiar With:** Linux CLI, Version Control (Git/GitHub), CI/CD basics, Performance Optimization

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## EXPERIENCE

### **Western Governors University**

*Student - Accelerated Computer Science Bachelor's and Master's Degree*

SEPT 2025 - PRESENT

- Pursuing advanced coursework in computer science with a focus on artificial intelligence, machine learning, and backend systems.
- Building on a strong foundation in programming and mathematics to deepen knowledge of algorithms, data structures, and system design.
- Developing independent coding projects that apply concepts in web development, server-side logic, and infrastructure to practical problems.
- Strengthening skills in clean, efficient software design with an emphasis on scalable, backend-focused solutions and emerging AI applications.

### **Mohawk School District, Bessemer, PA**

*Math & Computer Science Teacher | Help Desk*

AUGUST 2009 - PRESENT

- Teach dual-enrollment Calculus I (MATH 0220) and CS courses through University of Pittsburgh's College in High School Program.
- Teach Computer Hardware, Game Design (Godot), and Web Development classes, including CS 0012, CS 0134, and CS 0334 through University of Pittsburgh's College in High School Program.
- Provide technical support, manage computer labs, and assist with infrastructure during summer months.

### **Youngstown State University, Youngstown, OH**

*Part-Time Faculty - Statistics / College Algebra*

JANUARY 2008 - AUGUST 2020

- Instruct college-level Statistics and Algebra, integrating ALEKS learning software.
- Supported math success for undergraduates through a problem-solving and conceptual focus.

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## PROJECTS & APPLICATIONS

**Syntax Gym** [syntaxgym.replit.app](https://syntaxgym.replit.app)

A Flask-based coding platform for teaching HTML/CSS/JavaScript.

- Modular Flask backend using SQLite and Jinja templating
- Real-time syntax validation with custom input parser

**Quiz Playground** <https://github.com/sfranz2422/quiz-playground-new>

Dynamic Flask web app:

- Integrated authentication, dynamic assessments, and real-time feedback
- Designed and implemented database schema and caching logic
- Focused on deployment, routing, and RESTful architecture

**Red Leaf Lawn Care** <https://redlawns.com/>

Lawn Care Business Page with a Flask Backend

- Full-stack web application that streamlines customer contact and quote requests through a Flask-powered backend for input validation and submission management.

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## ADDITIONAL LINKS

- GitHub: <https://github.com/sfranz2422>
- LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/steve-j-franz-3538942b/>